

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp *****

MONDAY, MARCH 10, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXV NO. 56

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

Last week: DJIA 42801.72 ▼ 1039.19 2.37% NASDAQ 18196.22 ▼ 3.5% STOXX 600 553.35 ▼ 0.7% 10-YR. TREASURY ▼ 23/32, yield 4.317% OIL \$67.04 ▼ \$2.72 EURO \$1.0834 YEN 148.03

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Rattled by the threat** of trade restrictions and a slowing economy, some investors are turning to dividend-paying stocks in a move to defend portfolio values. **A1**

◆ **Trump's enthusiasm** for tariffs appears to overlook the history of past trade wars, which sometimes outlasted by decades the short-lived duties that sparked them. **A1**

◆ **Trump declined to rule** out that the U.S. economy would enter a recession this year, saying his economic agenda could cause short-term turbulence but would drive future prosperity. **A2**

◆ **European defense** stocks emerged as one of the biggest market winners this year as the Trump administration tries to remake the global security apparatus. **B1**

◆ **Hard-disk-drive makers**, under pressure from faster rivals, hope an innovative laser technology will help to keep them competitive. **B1**

◆ **French shipping magnate** Rodolphe Saadé met Trump at the White House and pledged to invest \$20 billion in the U.S. as the administration pushes to revive the American maritime sector. **B3**

◆ **CVS prepared to open** a dozen stores offering full-service pharmacies but limited retail, joining other drugstore chains responding to a stretch of declining retail sales. **B3**

◆ **Apple said it is delaying** an upgrade to Siri that is enhanced by artificial intelligence and expects to roll out the improved features later this year. **B4**

World-Wide

◆ **An accelerating advance** by Russian and North Korean forces threatens Ukraine's toehold in Kursk, the slice of Russian territory that Kyiv had hoped would give it leverage in any peace talks. **A1**

◆ **Republicans are** charging ahead with a proposal that would keep the federal government funded into the fall while reducing spending, setting up a clash with Democrats. **A1**

◆ **The Justice Department** released internal communications among prosecutors involved in the bribery case against Eric Adams that it said supported its decision to drop charges against the New York City mayor. **A3**

◆ **Republicans contending** for Mitch McConnell's Senate seat are distancing themselves from the Kentucky lawmaker as they angle for Trump's endorsement in a changed political environment. **A5**

◆ **Israel halted its** supply of electricity to the Gaza Strip as part of efforts to coerce Hamas into releasing Israeli hostages and giving up its arms, though Israel previously supplied little power to the enclave. **A7**

◆ **Mark Carney won the** leadership of Canada's Liberal Party, putting him in line to succeed Prime Minister Justin Trudeau and call an election that suddenly seems winnable for the country's center left. **A8**

◆ **Utah's governor** said he would sign a bill that bans the use of fluoride in public water systems, rejecting a widely used practice that public-health experts say is a crucial protector against tooth decay. **A3**

JOURNAL REPORT

Investing Monthly: Stocks don't always gain over the long run. **B5-6**

CONTENTS	Markets Digest..... B7
Arts in Review..... A13	Opinion..... A15-17
Business & Finance..... B29	Personal Journal A11-12
Business News..... B3	Sports..... A14
Crossword..... A14	Technology..... B4
Heard on Street..... B10	U.S. News..... A2-6
Journal Report..... B5-6	World News..... A7-8



© 2025 Dow Jones & Company, Inc. All Rights Reserved

Escalating Violence Tests Syria's New Leaders



SHOW OF GRIEF: Mourners in Qamishli, Syria, on Sunday attended the funeral of a woman who was killed in Latakia, one of the victims who perished in clashes between loyalists of deposed President Bashar al-Assad and the new Islamist rulers. **A7**

Wary Investors Play Defense In Switch to Dividend Stocks

By HANNAH ERIN LANG

Rattled by the threat of trade restrictions and a slowing economy, some investors are turning to a classic defensive play: dividend stocks.

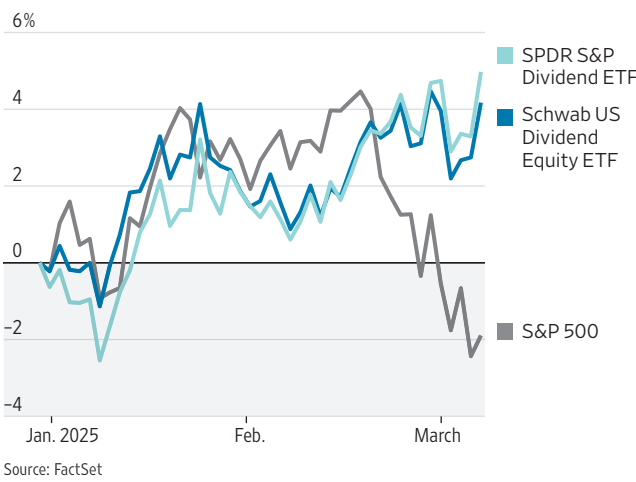
Shares of companies that offer relatively hefty cash payouts are beating the broader market this year. Some of the market's largest dividend-focused funds, such as Schwab US Dividend Equity ETF and SPDR S&P Dividend ETF, have risen more than 4% in 2025, even as major indexes slipped into the red.

Some of the largest dividend payers have posted significant gains. The S&P 500 Dividend Aristocrats—an index of companies that have raised dividends in each of the past 25 years—has returned about 3.5% this year, counting price changes and dividend payments as of Thursday's market close. The index constituents Coca-Cola and Johnson & Johnson have both notched double-digit-percent increases in 2025. Meanwhile, recent stock-market stars including Nvidia and Broadcom have sunk more

Please turn to page A6

◆ **James Mackintosh: Markets wake up to new reality ... B1**

Index and ETF performance this year



GOP Pushes to Unite On Funding-Cut Plan Supported by Trump

By KATY STECH FERREK

WASHINGTON—Republicans are charging ahead with a proposal endorsed by President Trump that would keep the government funded into the fall while reducing spending, setting up a clash with Democrats already steaming over sharp cuts to federal jobs and programs.

The proposal, if it clears a vote in the House as soon as Tuesday and then the Senate, would avoid a government shutdown this weekend and keep federal agencies funded through Sept. 30.

The House measure lowers nondefense discretionary spending by \$13 billion from the 2024 funding level, or 1.8% less, while increasing defense spending by about \$6 billion. It also boosts funding for border enforcement. The military funding is meant to win over defense hawks who have rejected past short-term measures they said have undermined the military.

Republican leaders have expressed confidence that they

Please turn to page A4

◆ **GOP infighting hampers tax bill's progress..... A4**

The Problem Hosting 'Love Is Blind' in Minnesota: Everything

Netflix hit showed the pitfalls of casting in a locale where everyone is connected

By INTI PACHECO

Peter Thibault was at a wedding last fall when someone at his table asked the others if they knew any cast members of the coming season of the Netflix hit "Love Is Blind."

Funny they should ask. Thibault's second cousin, Molly Mulaney, was on it. So was his high school prom date, Sara Carton. Then someone at the table said they had worked with Ben Mezzenga, another cast member. A third person said they were friends with Mezzenga, too.

The exchange foreshad-

owed what has become an undeniable reality for viewers of the latest season: Minnesota is a terrible place to host a dating show.

"Love Is Blind" tracks singles over the course of six weeks. It starts with a speed-dating round where contestants get engaged without seeing each other and follows them through an accelerated courtship. The show has become so popular that it has spawned legions of internet sleuths who try to pinpoint filming locations and living quarters to unearth the drama long before the world sees it.

Please turn to page A12

The America-Sized Hole In Ukraine's War Effort

The impact of suspending U.S. weapons and the sharing of intelligence will 'cascade and compound' over time

KYIV, Ukraine—The Russian army was advancing relentlessly in northeastern Ukraine in the summer of 2022 when the U.S. tipped the scales with new weapons and crucial battlefield intelligence.

By James Marson, Alistair MacDonald and Michael R. Gordon

The superior accuracy and greater range of M777 howitzers, supplied by the U.S., hit back against Russia's mostly Soviet-designed artillery. Then U.S. intelligence tipped off Ukraine's generals that Russia had moved several battalions to another front. Accurate U.S.-made rocket artillery struck Russian fuel depots and weapons stores, leaving the

Russian army short of supplies ahead of a rapid Ukrainian counteroffensive that retook dozens of towns.

Now, with Russia's military again grinding its way forward, the Trump administration has halted weapons deliveries and intelligence sharing that have been critical to Ukraine's resistance against a three-year invasion by its giant neighbor that has killed tens of thousands and razed dozens of cities.

The impact of the halt—which U.S. officials described as a temporary pause designed to force Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky to negotiate with Russia—will be limited at first, but is likely to grow over time as Ukraine's stocks of U.S. ammunition

Please turn to page A10

INSIDE



BUSINESS & FINANCE
What went wrong at a futuristic desert metropolis in Saudi Arabia? **B1**

SPORTS
Major League Baseball teams find relief for their starting-pitching needs at a bargain. **A14**

Trade Clashes' Effects Often Outlive the Tariffs

By DAVID UBERTI

President George W. Bush's tariffs on steel products were in place for less than two years. Their impact on the economy likely lasted far longer.

Designed to protect the beleaguered but politically influential U.S. steel industry, the 2002 tariffs raised costs for companies that used steel in auto parts, metal stamping and more. Though the tariffs were rescinded the next year, the affected companies became less competitive as they tried to sell their own products abroad, said Lydia Cox, an economics professor at the University of Wisconsin-Madison.

Businesses suffered. Jobs disappeared.

"The effects were really widespread," Cox said. Her research suggests they lingered

for a half-decade after Bush's tariffs were lifted.

President Trump's start-and-stop expansion of tariffs on major trading partners has no analog in modern history. Yet the past can still be instructive. Previous trade disputes over products from semiconductors to lumber to chickens have sometimes dragged out for decades, rattling international markets and boosting consumer prices.

None of the presidents who pursued those policies staked his agenda on protectionism to the same extent as Trump. His measures cover an array of products: beer from Mexico,

Please turn to page A2

◆ **Trump declines to rule out recession..... A2**
◆ **Heard on the Street: Home builders feel tariff pain....B10**